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Protocol Report

November 2026

Bitcoin, Ethereum and Solana



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Contents

- Core market views 3
- Current state of market 4
- Bitcoin data analysis 5
- Ethereum data analysis 7
- Solana data analysis 9
- Market outlook 13
- About Sygnum 15

About the report

Sygnum's Protocol Report is a monthly publication providing investors and digital asset users with a data-driven view of on-chain and market activity across Bitcoin, Ethereum and Solana, as well as their respective ecosystems.

This first edition covered core metrics over longer time horizons to establish a core baseline, with subsequent editions focusing on monthly changes in protocol utility, traction and indicators that shape market sentiment, volume and demand for the asset class.

For more information on the report, or if you are interested in exploring other on-chain metrics for these assets, please reach out to asset-management@sygnum.com or research@sygnum.com.

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Core market views

Macro conditions tightened through October. CPI came in at 3.7% alongside a firm PPI print, and the US 10-year yield rose to its highest level since 2002 before easing back toward 5.09%. The Federal Reserve held rates at 3.75–4.00% on 28 October, with two members dissenting in favour of a hike.

Pressure also came from outside crypto. Crude flows through the Strait of Hormuz partly recovered during the month, but attacks in the region increased late in October. An unwind in AI-linked equities spilled across risk assets, with Korea's Kospi falling around 20% in seven sessions. A major security incident at Binance on 29 October weighed on prices in the final days of the month.

Bitcoin fell around 7%, but it held above its September lows at month-end and declined far less than the major altcoins. US spot Bitcoin ETFs recorded a modest net outflow, their first negative month since July. Outflows were concentrated early in the month, and redemptions were small relative to total assets.

Ethereum came under heavier pressure. ETH fell around 16%, broke below its August support and touched a two-month low late in the month. US spot Ether ETFs recorded their largest monthly outflow of 2026. On the institutional side, JPMorgan brought JPM Coin, its US dollar deposit token, to Ethereum mainnet on 19 October.

SOL fell around 19%, the largest decline of the three, as its ETFs saw outflows. At the network level, Solana activated Alpenglow on mainnet on 21 October, its largest consensus upgrade to date, which targets finality of around 150ms. Tokenized real-world asset value on the network reached a new high of USD 5.1bn, and JPMorgan made its tokenized money market funds available on Solana on 22 October.

The month was marked by a divergence between prices and infrastructure. Prices fell across all three networks, while traditional finance continued to build on-chain. JPMorgan's launches went live on Ethereum and Solana, DTCC launched its tokenization service on 28 October, and OKXICE notified the SEC of plans for a tokenized stock venue on an Ethereum layer 2.

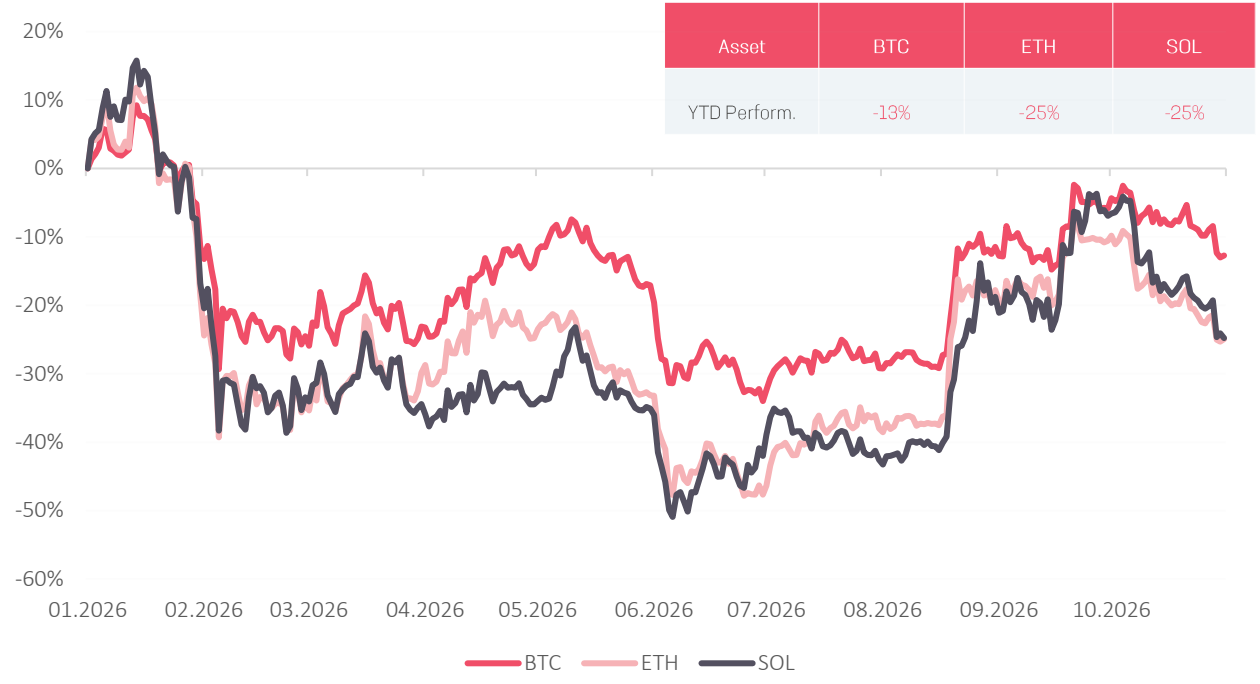
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October's macro pressure was compounded by the largest hack in crypto history, pushing the majors to monthly losses

State of the market

- October interrupted the two-month recovery, with all three majors posting losses as the macro backdrop deteriorated. SOL fell most at roughly -19% on the month, followed by ETH at about -16% and BTC at around -7%. The gap reflects investors cutting exposure to higher-beta assets more than to Bitcoin. Year-to-date losses widened as a result, reversing much of the improvement made over August and September.
- The month ended with a major shock. Late on 29 October, Binance lost about USD 6.3bn from its hot wallets. Around USD 3bn was frozen on-chain, with stablecoin issuers including Tether and Circle among those freezing funds. Binance has indicated there is enough to cover losses. The market reaction was sharp but contained. Bitcoin fell more than 4% within hours and triggered over USD 1.6bn in liquidations, while BNB dropped more than 8%. Prices stabilised as freezes and Binance's pledge to cover losses limited the immediate damage.



Source: CoinMarketCap API. Please note that past performance is no guarantee for future performance. Capital is at risk. *Performance since January, 2026

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Bitcoin held up comparatively well through a month of hot inflation, an equity sell-off and a major exchange hack

Bitcoin

On-chain activity

- Bitcoin closed October near USD 77k, down around 7% on the month. The decline was the smallest of the three majors, and Bitcoin held up comparatively well through the month's macro and market pressures.

Newsflow

- US spot Bitcoin ETFs recorded a modest net outflow of about USD 0.5bn in October, their first negative month since July. Outflows were concentrated early in the month, before flows recovered mid-month and weakened again late in October. Relative to total assets, redemptions were small, which suggests institutions paused rather than exited.

Ticker	Price*	Market cap	All-time high	/ price	/ drawdown
BTC	USD 77'434	USD 1.54T	Oct 06, 2025	USD 124,753	-38%

Bitcoin price



Source: CoinMarketCap API. Please note that past performance is no guarantee for future performance. Capital is at risk. *Bitcoin price data as of 31.10.2026

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ETF demand stalled in October as early-month outflows and the Binance hack offset mid-month inflows

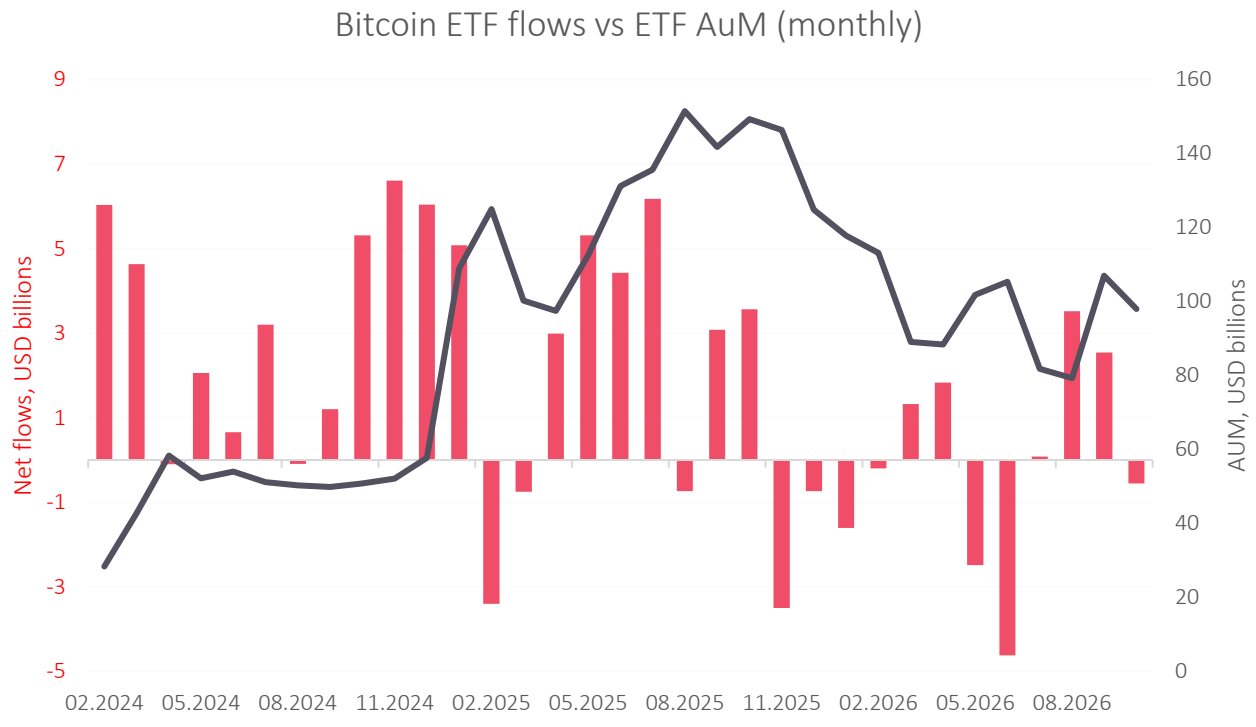
Bitcoin

Net flows

- US spot Bitcoin ETFs recorded a modest net outflow of about USD 0.5bn in October, the first negative month since July. Selling was concentrated early in the month. The funds lost around USD 679mn in the week of 5–9 October, including USD 487mn on 7 October alone, as the AI equity unwind and rising yields weighed on risk appetite. Flows then recovered, and by 21 October the monthly balance was close to flat at about USD 67mn of net outflows. Demand weakened again around the Binance hack at month-end.

Bitcoin ETF AuM

- Issuer AuM fell to around USD 98bn at month-end, down from about USD 108bn in September. The decline reflects Bitcoin's price fall more than outflows, since net redemptions were small relative to total assets. The flows suggest institutions paused rather than exited. Holders largely sat through a month of hot inflation, a hawkish Fed and the largest exchange hack on record, but they also did not add to positions.



Source: CoinMarketCap API, SoSoValue. Please note that past performance is no guarantee for future performance. Capital is at risk.

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ETH fell below its August support as ETF investors exited, while JPMorgan brought its deposit token to Ethereum mainnet

Ethereum

On-chain activity

- ETH fell around -16% in October, breaking below its August support and reaching a two-month low. US spot Ether ETFs recorded more than USD 1.6bn of outflows during the month, their largest monthly outflow of 2026.
- Ethereum spot DEX volume recorded its highest week since February during the week of the Binance hack. The spike likely reflects a mix of the attacker swapping stolen assets on-chain and broader market volatility, though the exact split is not yet clear.

Newsflow

- JPMorgan brought JPM Coin, its US dollar deposit token, to Ethereum mainnet on 19 October, alongside its existing deployment on Base. Kinexys said it chose Ethereum because so much on-chain liquidity and so many tokenized assets already sit there. It was one of several moves by traditional finance to put infrastructure on-chain during the month, covered on the following page.

Ethereum price

Ticker	Price*	Market cap	All-time high	/ price	/ drawdown
ETH	USD 2'253	USD 272B	Aug 24, 2025	USD 4'831	-53%



Source: CoinMarketCap API. Please note that past performance is no guarantee for future performance. Capital is at risk. *Ethereum price data as of 31.10.2026

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Traditional finance moved several layers of its infrastructure on-chain in October,

Ethereum

Ethereum mainnet and layer 2

- JPMorgan brought JPM Coin, its US dollar deposit token, to Ethereum mainnet on 19 October, alongside its deployment on Base. Kinexys said it chose Ethereum because so much on-chain liquidity and so many tokenized assets already sit there. JPMorgan's JLTXX fund, designed to support stablecoin issuers' reserve needs under the GENIUS Act, also runs on Ethereum and added Solana on 22 October. On the trading side, OKXICE, the joint venture of OKX and NYSE owner ICE, notified the SEC of plans for 24/7 trading in tokenized US stocks through Uniswap v4 pools on X Layer, OKX's Ethereum layer 2. No launch date has been set, and several of the proposed issuers have objected to inclusion.

Other networks

- Not every layer settled on Ethereum. DTCC launched its tokenization service on 28 October on Canton and a private network built with Besu, which is Ethereum client software, so the service does not run on public Ethereum. ICE and Trade[XYZ] also announced plans to run US perpetual futures on Hyperliquid, pending regulatory approval.

Layer	October move	Status	Network
Cash	JPM Coin, 19 Oct	**Live**	Ethereum mainnet
Reserves	JPM JLTXX, Ethereum May, Solana 22 Oct	**Live**	Ethereum, Solana
Trading	OKXICE SEC notice, 4 Oct	Planned	Uniswap v4 on X Layer
Post-trade	DTCC tokenisation service, 28 Oct	**Live**	Canton, private Besu
Derivatives	ICE and Trade[XYZ] plan, 29 Oct	Planned	Hyperliquid

Ethereum Ethereum layer 2 Other networks

Live means available to eligible users. Usage and issuance have not been disclosed.

Source: J.P. Morgan, DTCC, OKXICE public notices, CoinDesk, Hyperliquid. Please note that past performance is no guarantee for future performance. Capital is at risk.

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Solana activated its largest-ever upgrade and drew institutional products even as SOL fell with the broader market

Solana

On-chain activity

- SOL fell around 19% in October to close near USD 95. US spot Solana ETFs moved into outflows, ending the inflow streak that ran through September.
- Tokenised real-world asset value nonetheless reached a new all-time high of USD 5.1bn, up from about USD 4.3bn at the end of September. Stablecoin supply also held at around USD 16bn, close to September's record.

News Flow

- Solana activated Alpenglow on mainnet on 21 October, the largest consensus upgrade in its history. It targets finality of around 150ms, down from about 12.8 seconds under the previous design, and moves validator voting off-chain. Early mainnet readings have been above the target, so performance under sustained live conditions remains the key test.
- Institutions continued to choose Solana as a settlement rail. JPMorgan brought its tokenized money market funds to the network on 22 October, including JLTXX, a fund designed to hold reserves for stablecoin issuers under the GENIUS Act. Bank of North Dakota's Roughrider Coin went live on 1 October for more than 90 of the state's banks and credit unions.

Solana price

Ticker	Price*	Market cap	All-time high	/ price	/ drawdown
SOL	USD 95	USD 54B	Jan 19, 2025	USD 262	-64%



Source: CoinMarketCap API. Please note that past performance is no guarantee for future performance. Capital is at risk. *Solana price data as of 31.10.2026

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Solana activated Alpenglow, the largest consensus upgrade in its history

Solana

Alpenglow (SIMD-0326) LIVE ON MAINNET, 21 OCT

Replaces Solana's core consensus design

- Retires TowerBFT and Proof of History, replaced by the lighter Votor voting protocol
- Targets finality of around 150ms, down from roughly 12.8 seconds
- Moves validator voting off-chain, freeing the ~75% of block space votes used to consume
- Adds "20+20" resilience against malicious and offline stake
- Follows the move to 200ms slot times on 9 October, completing an 18-month build

What to watch KEY TESTS AHEAD

Performance under live conditions still to be proven

- 150ms is a design target, not yet measured over a sustained period
- Validator readiness was uneven ahead of launch
- Client diversity remains a key resilience risk
- Off-chain voting changes transaction counts, so headline figures may fall for technical reasons

Alpenglow shifts Solana's finality from seconds to milliseconds, strengthening its case as a settlement infrastructure for payments, stablecoins and tokenized assets. Performance under sustained live conditions remains the key test in the months ahead.

Source: Solana Foundation, SIMD-0326. Please note that past performance is no guarantee for future performance. Capital is at risk.

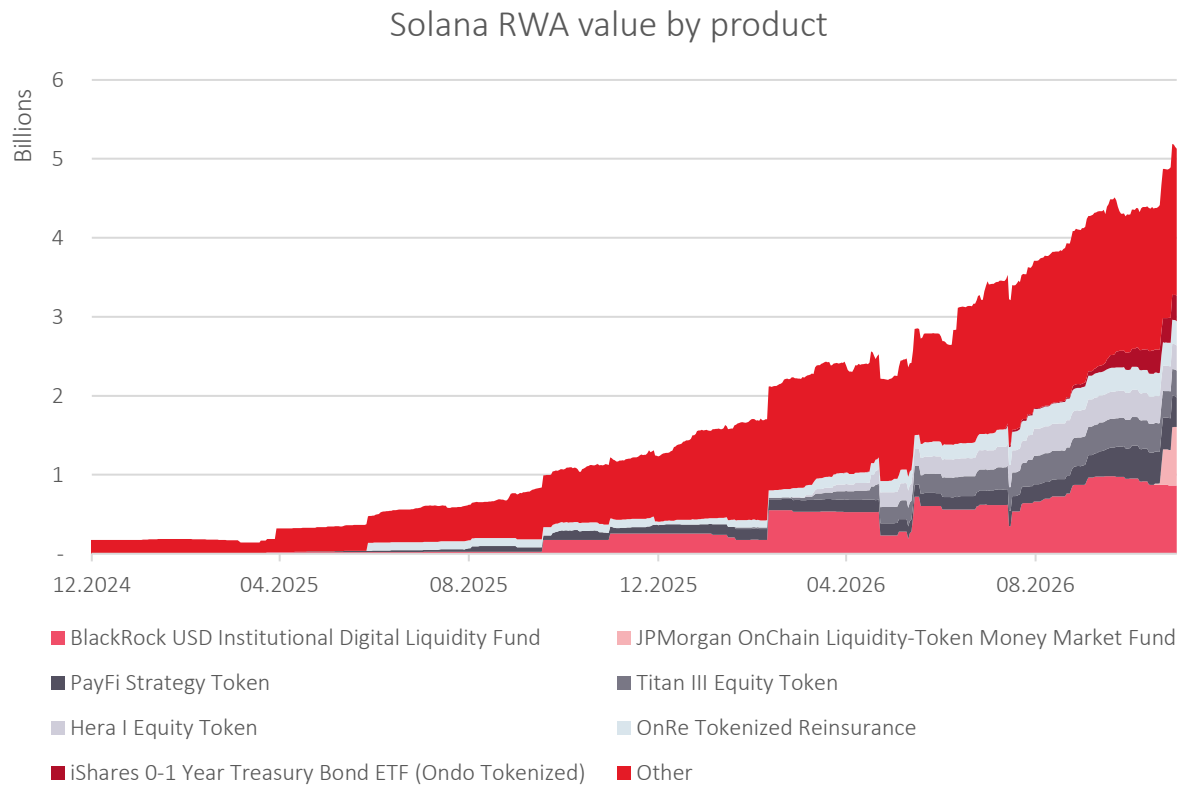
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Solana's tokenized RWA base climbed above USD 5bn as JPMorgan brought its tokenized money market funds to the network

Solana

- Tokenised real-world asset value on Solana reached a new all-time high in October, rising to about USD 5.1bn from roughly USD 4.3bn at the end of September.
- The most significant addition was JPMorgan's OnChain Liquidity-Token Money Market Fund (JLTXX). It is a US-registered government money market fund designed to meet reserve-asset requirements for stablecoin issuers under the GENIUS Act, investing in short-term Treasuries and overnight repurchase agreements. For a stablecoin issuer on Solana, this means a regulated reserve asset can now sit on the same network as its own stablecoin. JPMorgan has not disclosed how much capital it expects to hold on Solana, and the fund is still a small share of the total, but the entry of a global systemically important bank's cash products is a notable endorsement.
- The wider composition remains diverse. Tokenised Treasury and money market products from BlackRock and JPMorgan now sit alongside tokenized equities, private credit and alternative assets such as OnRe's tokenized reinsurance. The arrival of products built for stablecoin reserves adds an institutional cash-management layer to a base previously driven more by retail equity exposure.



Source: RWA.xyz. Please note that past performance is no guarantee for future performance. Capital is at risk.

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Solana's stablecoin base held near its record as banks increasingly chose it as their settlement rail

Solana

- Solana stablecoin supply held at around USD 16.1bn in October, just below September's record of about USD 16.8bn. The liquidity base largely stayed on the network through a stress month. Transfer volume eased to around USD 394bn from roughly USD 492bn in September, consistent with the broader cooling in trading activity.
- Bank-issued and bank-facing stablecoins continued to choose Solana. Roughrider Coin went live on 1 October, with four parties sharing the work. Bank of North Dakota sponsors the coin, Fiserv supplies the platform and banking front end, VersaBank issues it, and Fireblocks provides the digital asset infrastructure. It follows September launches by Column N.A., which made Solana the default chain for its native stablecoin rails, and SoFi, whose stablecoin settlement on Mastercard's network runs mostly on Solana. These products are restricted to institutional use, and Bank of North Dakota has not yet published supply or transaction data, so their scale is still to be shown.



Source: Artemis. Please note that past performance is no guarantee for future performance. Capital is at risk.

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Market outlook

Digital asset markets held up through a series of shocks in October. The month brought a hot CPI print, the highest US 10-year yield since 2002, a hawkish Fed with two dissents in favour of a hike, a sharp unwind in AI-linked equities, renewed attacks around the Strait of Hormuz and a major security incident at Binance. Despite this, Bitcoin fell only around 7% over the month, while ETH and SOL declined more sharply.

The outlook remains highly event-dependent, with the December FOMC, the Middle East and the US policy calendar the main swing factors.

On monetary policy, the Fed remains in a tightening stance after hiking in September and holding in October. As of late October, markets priced around an 80% probability of a hike at the 9 December meeting, making the October CPI and PPI releases ahead of that meeting key data points. The US 10-year yield has eased back toward 5% and the dollar index toward 102 from highs.

Geopolitical risk remains elevated. Crude flows through the Strait of Hormuz partly recovered in October, showing that supply can return quickly, but attacks in the region increased late in the month. A renewed rise in energy prices would add to inflation pressure ahead of the December meeting.

Regulatory progress continues through the agencies. The OCC issued its final rule implementing the GENIUS Act on 21 October, ahead of its November target, setting the federal framework for payment stablecoin issuers under its supervision. The rule and the Act take effect on 18 January 2027, with anti-money laundering and sanctions requirements to follow in a separate rulemaking. The SEC continues to act under its existing authority. Its Innovation Exemption, issued in September, received its first major application in October with the OKXICE tokenized stock venue notice.

At the network level, the next milestones are Ethereum's Glamsterdam upgrade, whose Hoodi testnet activation was postponed in October with no new date set. On tokenization, OKXICE's venue launch is anticipated, once the issuer objection period ends.

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About Sygnum

Sygnum is a global digital asset banking group, founded on Swiss and Singapore heritage.
We empower professional and institutional investors, banks, corporates and DLT foundations to invest in digital assets with complete trust. Our team enables this through our institutional-grade security, expert personal service and portfolio of regulated digital asset banking, asset management, tokenization and B2B services.

In Switzerland, Sygnum holds a banking licence and has CMS and Major Payment Institution licences in Singapore. The group is also regulated in the established global financial hubs of Abu Dhabi, Luxembourg and is registered in Liechtenstein.

We believe that the future has heritage. Our crypto-native team of banking, investment and digital asset technology professionals are building a trusted gateway between the traditional and digital asset economies that we call Future Finance. To learn more about how Sygnum's mission and values are shaping this digital asset ecosystem, please visit www.sygnum.com.

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